



MY BANGALORE JOURNEY

A Journey That Began With A Job Search — And Turned Into A Journey Of Compassion

1. THE CALL TO BANGALORE

There was a time when my sister and brother-in-law were living in HSR Layout, Bangalore. They were well settled there. One day, my brother-in-law encouraged me to try finding a job in the software field in Bangalore and suggested that I stay with them while searching.

I was excited by the idea. I already liked Bangalore, and I felt that the city might offer me a new beginning. After completing my engineering, I had spent nearly one and a half years struggling to find a suitable opportunity in the HAL area, particularly in the field of embedded systems. So, I decided to take his advice and travel to Bangalore.

2. LEARNING, TRYING — AND FACING DISAPPOINTMENT

Once I reached Bangalore, I enrolled in two different courses: ETL Development and Full Stack Development. I devoted around eight to ten months to learning and improving my technical skills. After completing the courses, I began applying for jobs.

But things did not go as I had hoped. Unfortunately, I could not find a job in either field. It was disappointing, but I continued moving forward.

3. MY FIRST JOB — AND A NEW CHAPTER

Eventually, I joined Countrees Technologies Private Limited in Varthur. It was a startup company working on two products, Biller and BillWallet, under the supervision of Software Developer Mr. Sanjay Panigrahi.

I worked there regularly from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. It was an important stage of my professional life. At the same time, something completely different was beginning to take shape in my life — something I had never planned.

4. THE DAY I MET ANURAG SAHAY VERMA

One holiday, while I was helping rescue a Labrador, I met Mr. Anurag Sahay Verma. During our casual conversation, he invited me to visit his place sometime.

I was excited by the invitation, so I planned to visit the following Sunday. Without

telling anyone, I went there.

What I saw at that place deeply inspired me.

5. A PLACE THAT CHANGED THE WAY I SAW ANIMALS

Inside WAGGCITY, a dog boarding centre that also served as a rescue and care space, I saw a cow, around fifteen to eighteen rescued Indian street dogs, several abandoned rescued dogs, and even a rescued pig. Outside the centre, around ten to fifteen street dogs were also being cared for.

I arrived around 4 p.m. and stayed until about 10 p.m. When I finally returned home, I felt strangely happy and fulfilled.

I began volunteering there on holidays and Sundays. Gradually, I joined their groups and met animal activists, rescuers, veterinarians and Reiki practitioners. Sometimes, I also helped rescuers during horse and donkey rescue operations. I became involved in cases related to goats being sacrificed at temples, followed adoption cases, and participated in street-dog feeding using my scooter.

Without realizing it, I was becoming part of a world that was completely different from my professional life.

6. THE ANIMALS OF HSR LAYOUT

At the same time, I was taking care of around twenty street dogs near HSR Layout. Sometimes, I also helped animals I encountered on my way to the office.

I had developed a strong interest in observing the lives of street animals, especially dogs and cows. I wanted to understand their behaviour, their struggles, their relationships and the way they survived in the middle of a busy city.

My life continued like this for several months — work on one side and animals on the other.

7. THE BBMP VAN — AND MY FIRST BIG QUESTION

Then, one day, I saw a BBMP van arrive in HSR Layout. I watched as innocent street dogs were caught forcefully using net-catching tools and taken into the van.

I immediately asked why they were being taken away.

I was told that they had been instructed to remove the dogs from the locality and that, after sterilization or spaying/neutering, the dogs would be returned to the same locality.

At that time, this sounded very strange to me. I had never heard about this process before. I simply wanted to know what would happen to the dogs I knew and cared for.

8. SEARCHING FOR MY FRIENDS

After about a week, I became increasingly restless because the dogs had not yet returned. I decided to visit the BBMP office myself.

When I asked about the dogs, I was told, in effect, to trust the process and that the dogs would be brought back the following week.

The next day, following directions from the staff, I searched another place where I was told the dogs might be kept. Eventually, I found a temporary-shelter-like area where many dogs were being housed.

At that moment, I realized that some good work was indeed being carried out by BBMP. But another question remained in my mind: if the process was happening, why had my friends from HSR Layout not come back?

I was allowed to check whether the dogs from my locality were there. I searched, but I could not find them.

I was told to wait a few more days and assured that they would return. So I waited.

9. THREE WEEKS LATER

After about three weeks, the dogs finally returned.

I felt genuinely happy to see them again.

That experience changed something inside me. I had started with a simple concern for a few street dogs, but the experience pushed me to understand the larger world of animal welfare — rescue, sterilization, treatment, rehabilitation and responsible care.

10. WHAT WAGGCITY TAUGHT ME

Gradually, through my association with WAGGCITY, the boarding-cum-rescue centre, I began learning many things.

I learned about the Animal Birth Control (ABC) process and gained practical exposure to the care and treatment of dogs suffering from illnesses such as Parvo and Canine Distemper (CD). I learned how seriously maggot-infested wounds can affect an animal, and I gained basic practical knowledge of IM and SC injections and a little understanding of IV fluids under appropriate supervision.

I also learned how to socialize dogs, how to care for them, how to select suitable food, and how important patience, observation and consistency are when dealing with rescued animals.

More importantly, I learned that helping an animal is not simply about giving food or treatment. It is about understanding fear, pain, trust and recovery.

11. THE BEGINNING OF SOMETHING BIGGER

What began in Bangalore as a simple attempt to find a software job gradually became something much deeper.

I had gone to Bangalore looking for professional stability. Instead, I discovered another direction in life — one that brought me closer to animals, rescuers, veterinarians, volunteers and countless stories of suffering and survival.

The city gave me professional experience, but the animals gave me a different kind of education — an education of compassion, responsibility and courage.

□□ MORAL OF THE JOURNEY □□

Sometimes, we travel to a place searching for one destination, but life quietly opens the door to another. A failed job search can become a lesson; a rescued animal can become a teacher; and a small act of kindness can become a lifelong mission.

MY JOURNEY STARTED FROM HERE...